

THE DARK HIERARCHY

A Metaphysics of Desire, Authority, and Bodily Custody

ECHO KRONBORG · CARRIER OF DECHO · BERLIN

Desire is not only what you feel toward another person, but what you feel about yourself in their presence.

A completed work of erotic philosophy, speculative theology, and field testimony that challenges the Lacanian doctrine of lack from inside lived hierarchical practice. Five books and a coda, typeset as a 6 × 9 in trade volume, with a seven-instrument digital companion that gives every reader a private way back into the argument.

381 PAGES	67,310 WORDS	5 + Coda BOOKS	21 MOVEMENTS	7 INSTRUMENTS	37 SCHOLARLY NOTES
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The audience is measurable, and large

Independent research and event data show that the book’s subject is not a fringe curiosity. Third-party figures below are market context, with sources on page 2; they are not projections for this title.

46.8% OF BELGIAN ADULTS had performed at least one BDSM-related activity; 12.5% do so regularly and 7.6% self-identify as practitioners. ¹	45.6% OF QUEBEC ADULTS reported interest in at least one behaviour DSM-5 classes as atypical; 33% had experienced one (n = 1,040). ²	20,000+ FOLSOM EUROPE, BERLIN visitors expected at the 2025 edition, up from about 3,500 at the first, per the organiser. ³
16,600 DARKLANDS, ANTWERP admissions sold in presale for 2024, with 437 performers and 290 vendors. ⁴	8-11M FETLIFE ACCOUNTS estimated registered members worldwide. Figures vary by source and are not independently audited. ⁵	165M+ FIFTY SHADES, COPIES sold worldwide per its publisher: proof of mass readership for the subject, in a very different register. ⁶

Six readerships, one book

- Leather, kink and BDSM communities, and households practising hierarchy: the book is written from inside this world.

— Continental philosophy and critical theory readers, the Semiotext(e) and Repeater constituency: Lacan, Bataille, Bersani, Han, Weil, Foucault.

— Queer and gender-studies scholars and students: a full theoretical apparatus and glossary, a scholarly engagement with more than 25 named thinkers and traditions, and a 15-week seminar syllabus.
- Spiritual and pastoral readers: liturgy, canticles, and dark-night material engage Weil, Otto, Turner, Nouwen, and Loder.

— Cultural programming audiences in Berlin and Northern Europe: festivals, galleries, reading series, and philosophy nights.

— BDSM-ethnography readers: the apparatus engages Margot Weiss, Gayle Rubin, and Staci Newmahr directly.

Six story angles for press

- “Against Lacan, from inside the dungeon.” A theory book that tests its argument against lived practice rather than the clinic.
- A book with a private companion. Seven instruments, local-first storage, no analytics, and an 18+ gate: the opposite of a data-harvesting app.
- The author audits himself. The book is “not a confession; it is version control,” and its twentieth movement analyses the author’s own relationship record.
- “God has two neighbors: Order and Humor.” Bergman’s dictum turned into a household philosophy: quotable, funny, serious.
- Berlin as a leather capital. A natural partner for Folsom Europe week and the city’s fetish and queer cultural calendar.
- Consent as theology. Revocability and autonomy are stated as preconditions on page one, answering the “is this safe?” question before it is asked.

Four returns from one work

PUBLICATIONS

Monograph, validation paper, replication, practitioner companion.

SCIENCE

Six falsifiable hypotheses; anonymous-by-design data pipeline; open to institutional co-projects.

REFLECTION

Seven private instruments that give readers value the same day.

TURNKEY PR

Try it in minutes, share a comparison link, scan the QR on p. 312.

Programming and partnerships

- Reading series and philosophy nights built around single movements: the 21-movement structure is modular.
- Festival and gallery talks in the Folsom Europe and Darklands orbit, subject to invitation and partner programming.
- University adoption: a 15-week graduate syllabus (Philosophy / GSWS) is included in the proposal kit.
- Instrument-led workshops: each of the seven tools is a 5–12 minute reflective exercise (115 prompts in total) that can anchor a session.

What the product team can expect

Is the manuscript finished?

Yes. Release edition v122, 381 pages, 0 errors and 0 undefined references in the last clean two-pass build. Full PDF on request.

Is there a digital product to launch with?

Yes, live at echoxstudios.art/tdh: seven instruments, shareable partner comparison, private retrieval codes, optional emailed results.

Is it responsibly built?

Adults only; local-first by default; cross-device storage only on explicit consent; no marketing cookies; no result statistics sent for analytics; non-diagnostic by design.

What we do not claim. No clinical validity. No sales forecast. No claim that the Echo-System has collected research data, or that the reference overlay is a census. Third-party figures describe the wider field, not this title’s expected reach.

SOURCES, ACCESSED 2 OCTOBER 2026

- Holvoet L. et al., “Fifty Shades of Belgian Gray: The Prevalence of BDSM-Related Fantasies and Activities in the General Population,” *Journal of Sexual Medicine*, 2017. pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/28781214
- Joyal C.C. & Carpentier J., “The Prevalence of Paraphilic Interests and Behaviors in the General Population: A Provincial Survey,” *Journal of Sex Research* 54(2), 2017. pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/26941021; summary at eurekalert.org/news-releases/674264
- FolsomEurope e.V., via place2be.berlin/en/discover-berlin/folsom-europe-berlin-all-essential-informations-and-data (organiser figures).
- Darklands 2024 post-event report, tripbytrip.org/2024/03/08/darklands-2025-theme-darklands-glows-stays-at-waagnatie-until-2030
- FetLife membership: third-party estimates range from about 8 to 11 million registered accounts; self-reported, unaudited.
- Penguin Random House, Fifty Shades of Grey series page, penguinrandomhouse.com/series/FS3/fifty-shades-of-grey-series (“more than 165 million copies sold worldwide”).

Request the manuscript and submission package

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